

# BRIAN SHIMKUS

FORWARD-DEPLOYED / APPLIED AI ENGINEER

CUSTOMER SYSTEMS / INTEGRATIONS / REGULATED WORKFLOWS

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Forward-deployed / applied AI engineer with 12 years delivering customer-facing software and integration-heavy workflows, including regulated financial services. Led broker and trader onboarding modernization at Marex, integrated the DocuSign API, ran stakeholder discovery and demonstrations, and managed a five-person team. Builds Salesforce, RAG, and API systems with OAuth 2.0/JWT, source-grounded outputs, human review, and reliability controls for idempotency, webhook handling, retries, and reconciliation.

## SKILLS

### CORE EXPERTISE

|                   |                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| APPLIED AI        | OpenAI API, LLMs, RAG, LangChain, Pinecone/vector databases, Structured Outputs, evals, guardrails, Python, FastAPI                   |
| INTEGRATIONS      | Salesforce API, DocuSign API, REST, JSON, OAuth 2.0/JWT, webhooks, SQL, MySQL, AWS                                                    |
| ENGINEERING       | TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Git, Jest, Playwright, Vercel                                   |
| CUSTOMER DELIVERY | Discovery, problem decomposition, workflow mapping, demos, proof of concept/value (POC/POV), stakeholder alignment, technical handoff |

## WHERE I'VE DELIVERED

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### Independent Applied AI & Integration Engineer

Dec 2025 - Present

##### Insolla / Consulting and portfolio practice

- Build customer-facing AI and integration systems across CRM intelligence, identity governance, and document operations, connecting live third-party platforms through REST APIs, webhooks, and automation tooling.
- Reduced a client's social-media workflow from 8 hours/week to 10 minutes through an automated content pipeline scoped and delivered directly with the owner.
- Translate discovery into solution walkthroughs, security briefs, proof-of-value plans, and documented technical handoff, keeping customer decisions, data risks, and implementation tradeoffs explicit.
- Design Salesforce integrations with scoped access, OAuth 2.0 JWT authentication, source grounding, human review, and documented data controls.

#### Lead Front-End Developer

Aug 2025 - Dec 2025

##### TerraFort / Freelance

- Led design and development of an early-stage web and mobile platform from concept through delivery.
- Owned vendor evaluations and scoped third-party and AI integrations with UX, product, and backend teams.

#### Senior Front-End Developer

Jul 2024 - Jun 2025

##### OCC / Contract

- Ran weekly stakeholder sessions at a systemically important financial market utility, aligning goals, demonstrating progress, and resolving open questions across workstreams.
- Delivered React and TypeScript solutions from Figma through test, QA, and production; implemented Mock Service Worker to unblock development from backend dependencies.

#### Lead Front-End Developer

Oct 2020 - Jan 2024

##### Marex

- Led the program that digitized broker and trader onboarding at a global financial-services firm, replacing a compliance-heavy paper workflow with an end-to-end digital process.
- Won adoption from trading and operations teams by partnering with compliance and operations stakeholders to scope each rollout.
- Integrated the DocuSign API to digitize document signing across products.
- Led a five-person front-end team delivering stakeholder-driven solutions; designed and ran the team's internship program.

SELECTED WORK

FEATURED FORWARD-DEPLOYED SYSTEMS

Casefile - Investigation Copilot

IN PROGRESS

Designing an investigation copilot for a fictional insurance Special Investigations Unit that will ingest five disagreeing claims sources, resolve claimant, vehicle, vendor, and policy entities, flag conflicts and anomalies, and answer investigator questions with cited evidence.

**Evaluation plan:** Entity-resolution precision, recall, and false-merge rate; retrieval recall, citation correctness, and unsupported-answer rate; zero duplicate records or tasks across forced write re-runs.

**Safety and status:** Evidence assembly and human escalation only - never fraud labeling, coverage denial, or adverse action. Phase 0 discovery is underway; planned scope spans multi-source ingestion, deterministic scoring, RAG/tool orchestration, live APIs, cloud deployment, and security testing.

[Case study](#) | [Source code](#)

Salesforce Intelligence

LIVE DEMO

Retrieval-augmented assistant that answers natural-language questions across Salesforce Cases, Accounts, and Opportunities. Synchronizes records into Pinecone and returns responses linked to source CRM rows. Built with Python, LangChain, and OpenAI.

**Demonstrated outcome:** Converts a multi-record CRM lookup into one sourced response in seconds.

**Controls:** OAuth 2.0 JWT, scoped fields, server-side credentials, source citations, and explicit unsupported-answer handling.

[Case study](#) | [Live demo](#) | [Source code](#)

FOUNDATION

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                                                                                              |                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Senior Front-End Developer / <a href="#">Walker &amp; Dunlop</a> (Contract) - Built Vue.js and Storybook components connected to APIs.                       | Mar 2020 - Oct 2020 |
| Senior Front-End Developer / <a href="#">ICF</a> - Led the front-end lifecycle and standardized web accessibility across projects.                           | Jan 2019 - Mar 2020 |
| Front-End Developer / <a href="#">TransUnion</a> - Built a Contentful-based CMS for marketing owners and deployed to AWS.                                    | Jan 2018 - Jan 2019 |
| UX Architect and Front-End Developer / <a href="#">R1 RCM</a> - Identified gaps with directors and prototyped AngularJS solutions.                           | Apr 2016 - Jan 2018 |
| Front-End Developer / <a href="#">TimeZoneOne</a> (Contract) - Built WordPress themes for Athletico and the Chicago Wolves.                                  | Aug 2015 - Apr 2016 |
| Junior Front-End Developer / <a href="#">Kohactive</a> - Built Rails/SASS sites and led client meetings with Aon, Manchester United, and The Vitality Group. | Aug 2013 - Aug 2015 |

EDUCATION

FORMAL TRAINING

|                                                                                                         |             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design / <a href="#">Art Institute of Chicago</a> - 3.9 GPA, Dean's List | 2013        |
| Instructional Design and Technology / <a href="#">Western Illinois University</a>                       | 2008 - 2010 |